

playing into the hands of the real villain—the Pakistan Army. India and the international community should focus on ensuring true democracy in Pakistan by supporting the elected government so that it can put the army and its terror wing ISI in place.

Only a strong, democratic Pakistan is the best insurance against terrorism.

S. SENGUPTA, *Kolkata*,
via www.indiatoday.in

Neighbour Trouble

The Mumbai siege and subsequent carnage is just one of the several outrages of jihadi elements emanating from Pakistan ("Tackling Pakistan", December 15). The Pakistan President's U-turn from his earlier assurance to assist India in reaching the roots of terror in his country, and even hand over 20-odd fugitives, was astonishing. India must not hesitate to bomb the terror camps located in PoK to register our protest and discourage any such future misadventures.

S. LAKSHMI,
via www.indiatoday.in

Test of Patience

It is a matter of immense angst that politicians unhesitatingly and blatantly mix terrorism with politics ("Hardselling Terror", December 1). They do it either to woo minority votebanks or to gain brownie points at the expense of other political parties. Terrorism of

catastrophic dimensions has plagued India. The need of the hour is to pre-empt it. And this resoluteness and unanimity must be the first thought among all politicians across party lines.

INDU SHANKAR,
via www.indiatoday.in

Tainted Image

The arrest of Lt-Colonel Srikant Prasad Purohit has tarnished the image of the Indian Army ("The ATS Flip-Flop", December 1). An exception which hopefully won't make a rule. Purohit, if proved guilty for his involvement in

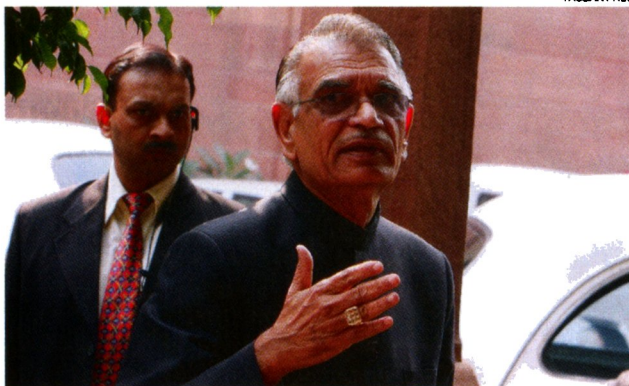
never compromised. This is the reason why the army is the bedrock of the nation.

MADHU R.D. SINGH,
via www.indiatoday.in

Corrigendum

One of the items in the Business and Economy section ("Scam, Scandal and Shame", December 22, 2008), erroneously mentioned that former Union minister Natwar Singh and his son Jagat were indicted for procuring contracts in the United Nation oil-for-food programme in Iraq. They were not. In fact, the re-

YASBANT NEGI



“ In India, politicians are often responsible but rarely held accountable for the miseries of the common people, most of which are the result of their misdeeds and inaction. ”

MANOJ KUMAR, via www.indiatoday.in

anti-national activities, however, will be an exception. The army has a very fine system of checks and balances. Strict and prompt action is taken against defaulters, and national interest is

port of the Justice R.S. Pathak Inquiry Authority said "there is no material to show that Natwar Singh derived any financial or other personal benefits from the contracts". The error is regretted.

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Work of Art

He has made more money than any of his contemporaries, but his lifestyle resembles that of an impoverished gypsy. He circulates among the so-called jet set, but does not drink, smoke or adopt the vices currently considered de rigueur. He makes appointments by the dozen, and misses all of them. He is lionised and feted by all of the beautiful people, but can count his friends on the fingers of one hand. He wears the same outfit for days in a row and takes his afternoon nap curled up in the back seat of his Fiat. The lifestyle may be odd, the gestalt a little too casual. But at 64, Maqbool Fida Husain has out-painted every other Indian artist. He has done more, in artistic terms, to elevate the status of Indian art to an international level than any of his contemporaries, and samples of his prodigious output adorn some of the best-known art collections in the world.

Dilip Bobb and Arati Jerath

